06.1w – Contention and claims

Mentor text: Courier Mail reading copy (05.1r), "Why delaying social media is the best gift we can give our children" by Eleni Paneras, The Courier Mail

Part 1: What makes a strong contention?

A contention is the writer's position on the issue: what they want you to think or do. A strong contention:

- takes a side
- is specific
- is a statement, not a question.

Rewrite each of these so it is a strong contention.

Not a contention yet	A stronger contention might be:
Social media is bad.	
Is lunchtime too short?	

Part 2: Eleni Paneras' contention

Her headline is "Why delaying social media is the best gift we can give our children". Find the sentence in Section 3 where she states her position directly. It starts with "That's why I support...". Write the paragraph number, then copy the sentence.

_____

_____

Part 3: Find the claims

A claim is a reason the writer gives to show that her contention is true. Tick the three sentences that are claims Eleni Paneras makes. Write the paragraph number where you found each one.

✓	Sentence	Paragraph
	Parents cannot win against tech companies that design apps to keep children hooked.	
	The writer's son is eight years old.	
	Social media makes young people measure their worth in likes and views.	
	Social media helps young people find support and community.	
	We would never give children alcohol or cigarettes, so we should not give them social media either.	
	Mixtapes used to be recorded off the radio.	

Which of the three claims do you find most persuasive? Why?

I find this claim the most persuasive because ...

_____

_____

Part 4: My contention and claims

Copy your topic and issue from 05.1w. Then write your contention and three claims. Write each claim as a full sentence. Stuck for a claim? Ask yourself: who does this issue affect, and how?

	My plan
My topic	
My issue	
My contention ☐ It takes a side. ☐ It is specific. ☐ It is a statement, not a question.	
Claim 1	*One reason is that …*
Claim 2	*Another reason is that …*
Claim 3	*Most importantly, …*

Exit ticket

My strongest claim is _____

because _____